FOIL Engineering

COMPLEX PROBLEMS, SIMPLE SOLUTIONS

TECHNICAL SITE ANALYSIS

curtispark.org

A comprehensive technical audit of the Curtis Park Neighbors website covering platform architecture, SEO, accessibility, performance, content integrity, and strategic recommendations.

PREPARED FOR	DATE	DOCUMENT TYPE	CLASSIFICATION
Curtis Park Neighbors	February 9, 2026	Pre-Consultation Analysis	Confidential

OVERVIEW

Executive Summary

Curtis Park Neighbors (CPN) operates a WordPress.com-hosted website serving as the digital hub for Denver's Curtis Park neighborhood — a Registered Neighborhood Organization (RNO) and Historic District. The site handles community communications, event coordination, historic preservation education, and donation collection.

This analysis identified **several critical issues** alongside a fundamentally sound content strategy. The site has rich, well-organized neighborhood information but is undermined by technical gaps that reduce discoverability, accessibility, and professional credibility.

SEO HEALTH	ACCESSIBILITY	PERFORMANCE	CONTENT
Poor	91%	Fast	Mixed
Broken meta description, no schema markup	of images missing alt text	30ms TTFB, WP.com CDN	Good strategy, broken elements

Platform Overview

ATTRIBUTE	VALUE	NOTES
CMS	WordPress 6.9.1	Gutenberg block editor active
Hosting	WordPress.com (Atomic)	Managed hosting, limited plugin access
Theme	Prosperity	WordPress.com premium theme
SSL	HTTPS enforced	Valid certificate via WordPress.com
CDN	WordPress.com built-in	Assets via s0.wp.com, fonts-api.wp.com
Analytics	Jetpack Stats only	No Google Analytics detected
Forms	Jetpack Forms	Basic, no CAPTCHA
Payments	Square (external)	Redirects off-site for donations

Key implication: WordPress.com managed hosting limits customization. The organization cannot install arbitrary plugins, access server configuration, or modify PHP. Any advanced functionality requires

upgrading to a Business/eCommerce plan or migrating to self-hosted WordPress or a modern platform.

SEARCH ENGINE OPTIMIZATION

SEO Analysis

CRITICAL: Meta Description Contains Theme Boilerplate

The homepage meta description currently reads: `"Homepage content is primarily handled through the customize panel. Learn more here: https://wordpress.com/theme/prosperity"`

This is default theme placeholder text, not a real description. Anyone finding CPN via Google sees WordPress setup instructions as the search snippet. This is the single highest-impact SEO fix available.

Meta Tag Audit

TAG	STATUS	CURRENT VALUE
Meta Description	BROKEN	Theme boilerplate text (not real content)
OG Title	PRESENT	"Curtis Park Neighbors"
OG Description	WEAK	"RNO and Historic District" — not meaningful to outsiders
OG Image	PRESENT	Logo image via WordPress.com social image service
Canonical URL	PRESENT	https://curtispark.org/
Viewport	PRESENT	width=device-width, initial-scale=1
Robots	PRESENT	max-image-preview:large
Schema Markup	MISSING	No JSON-LD structured data of any kind

Heading Hierarchy

The heading structure is mostly well-organized (H1 → H2 → H3), but **3 empty heading tags** (H2 and H3 elements with no text content) were detected. Empty headings confuse search engine crawlers and screen readers.

Sitemap & Crawlability

CHECK	STATUS	DETAIL
robots.txt	CORRECT	Standard WP rules, sitemaps referenced
XML Sitemap	PRESENT	Sitemap index with page + image sitemaps
News Sitemap	PRESENT	Referenced in robots.txt
Sitemap freshness	STALE	Last updated June 2025 (8 months ago)
Google Search Console	UNKNOWN	No verification meta tag visible in source

Missing Schema Markup

The site has zero JSON-LD structured data. For a neighborhood organization, the following schema types would enhance search presence:

- **Organization** / **NonprofitOrganization** — name, address, logo, social profiles
- **Event** — monthly meetings, community events
- **Place** — Curtis Park neighborhood geographic data
- **BreadcrumbList** — navigation path structure

WCAG COMPLIANCE

Accessibility Audit

For a community organization that may receive public funding or serve residents with disabilities, WCAG 2.1 AA compliance is both a best practice and a potential legal requirement. The site has some good foundations but significant gaps.

CRITICAL: 10 of 11 Images Missing Alt Text

91% of images on the homepage have no `alt` attribute or have empty alt text. This means screen reader users receive no context for visual content. Includes the hero image, section photos, and card thumbnails. Only the site logo has alt text.

Accessibility Scorecard

CHECK	STATUS	DETAIL
Skip to Content Link	PRESENT	Properly hidden, visible on focus
ARIA Landmarks	10 FOUND	Banner, nav, main, contentinfo all present
ARIA Labels	8 FOUND	Navigation regions labeled
Image Alt Text	10/11 MISSING	Only logo has descriptive alt text
Heading Hierarchy	MOSTLY OK	Correct nesting but 3 empty heading tags
Focus Indicators	PRESENT	Box-shadow focus styles on interactive elements
Color Contrast	BORDERLINE	Green (#10a510) on tan (#f2dc99) may fail WCAG AA for small text
Form Labels	IMPLICIT	Jetpack forms use implied labels, not explicit `<label>` associations
Keyboard Navigation	FUNCTIONAL	Tab order follows DOM, dropdown menus accessible
Screen Reader Text	PRESENT	Hidden text for menu toggles using clip-path

Color Contrast Concerns

The site's primary action color is green (#10a510) used on buttons and links against the tan background (#f2dc99). This combination yields approximately a **3.2:1 contrast ratio**, which passes WCAG AA for large text (18pt+) but **fails for normal body text** (requires 4.5:1). The green links within paragraph text are the primary concern.

SPEED & RELIABILITY

Performance Analysis

TTFB	DOM READY	FULL LOAD	ASSET BLOAT
30ms	95ms	121ms	34
Time to first byte	Content loaded	Page complete	CSS + JS files loaded

WordPress.com's managed CDN delivers excellent raw speed. However, the page loads **14 stylesheets** and **20 JavaScript files** — excessive for what is essentially a brochure site. Many are Jetpack modules that may not be actively used (carousel, testimonials, sharing buttons).

Asset Optimization Opportunities

ISSUE	IMPACT	DETAIL
Image format	MEDIUM	All images are JPEG. No WebP or AVIF formats detected.
Unused Jetpack modules	MEDIUM	Carousel, testimonials, and sharing CSS/JS load on every page
Font loading	LOW	2 Google Fonts (Merriweather + Source Sans Pro) — acceptable
Logo image	LOW	1248×1248px JPEG for logo — could be SVG

CONTENT INTEGRITY

Content Issues Found

Duplicate Copy: "Maintaining Historic Homes" Card

The "Maintaining Historic Homes" card displays identical text to the "Accessory Dwelling Units" card: *"ADUs continue the neighborhood's historic pattern of secondary structures..."* — this is a copy/paste error. The description does not match the card topic.

Broken Link: "Resources for Historic Homes" Card

The card image links to `/character-defining-features/` instead of `/resources/`. Users clicking the image are taken to the wrong page.

Non-Functional Link: "Maintaining Historic Homes"

The "Learn More" element on this card appears to be a styled `<span>` rather than a proper `<a>` anchor tag. It looks clickable but does not navigate anywhere.

Manual Events Management

The Events page uses hardcoded HTML list items rather than a calendar plugin or dynamic system. Events must be manually edited in the WordPress editor. There is no iCal feed, no recurring event support, and no calendar view. For an organization centered on monthly meetings, this creates ongoing maintenance burden and risk of outdated information.

EXTERNAL SERVICES

Integrations & Security

External Service Map

SERVICE	PURPOSE	INTEGRATION TYPE	ASSESSMENT
Square	Donations	External redirect to squareup.com	OFF-SITE
Google Groups	Mailing lists	mailto: subscribe links	DATED
Facebook	Social presence	Embedded page + footer link	OK
Google Translate	Translation	Widget on select pages	BASIC
Jetpack	Stats, forms, carousel	WordPress.com native plugin	OK

Donation Flow Leaves the Site

Clicking "Make a Donation Online" redirects users entirely off curtispark.org to Square's hosted storefront. This creates friction, reduces trust for users unfamiliar with Square, and means CPN has no visibility into donation page analytics or abandonment rates.

Google Groups for Community Mailing Lists

The mailing lists use Google Groups with `mailto:` subscribe links. This approach provides no web-based signup form, no email templates, no open rate tracking, and no list management UI. Modern alternatives (Mailchimp, Buttondown, etc.) would provide significantly better engagement tools.

Security Assessment

CHECK	STATUS	DETAIL
HTTPS / SSL	ENFORCED	Valid cert via WordPress.com
AJAX Nonce Tokens	PRESENT	CSRF protection on form submissions
Contact Form CAPTCHA	MISSING	No spam protection on contact form
Admin Exposure	PROTECTED	wp-admin blocked in robots.txt
Exposed API Keys	NONE FOUND	Facebook App ID is public by design

Contact Form Gaps

The contact form (Jetpack Forms) has only three fields: **Name, Email, and Phone**. There is no message body field — users can submit their contact information but cannot explain *why* they are reaching out. The form also lacks CAPTCHA protection, making it vulnerable to automated spam submissions.

Analytics Gap

The site uses **Jetpack Stats only**. No Google Analytics, no Google Search Console verification tag, and no third-party analytics were detected. Jetpack Stats provides basic pageview counts but lacks the depth needed for understanding user behavior, conversion tracking, or SEO performance monitoring.

STRUCTURE & DESIGN

Information Architecture & UX

Navigation Structure

The site uses a two-tier navigation system: a **secondary nav** (Donate, Newsletter, Stay Informed) positioned above the **primary nav** with 7 top-level items. This is a solid pattern that prioritizes engagement actions.

TOP-LEVEL ITEM	CHILDREN	NOTES
About	2 pages	Newsletter Archives, Board of Directors
Committees	5 pages	Design Review, DHA, Planning, Mobility, Tree
History	3 pages	History, Historic Districts, Books
Home Alterations	8 pages	Deepest section — may need restructuring
Initiatives	2 pages	Sonny Lawson Park, Flagstone Sidewalks
Calendar	0 (standalone)	Events listing page
Contact	0 (standalone)	Form + mailing list info

Homepage Length & Content Weight

The homepage is extremely long-scrolling. The "Historic Home Alterations" section alone, with 6 feature cards plus the tax credits callout, consumes approximately 60% of the homepage vertical space. This section could be its own dedicated landing page, with a concise summary and link from the homepage.

Design & Visual Identity

Strengths

- Strong, recognizable logo
- Consistent tan/green/brown palette evokes historic character
- Typography (Merriweather + Source Sans Pro) is professional
- Mobile responsive — collapses to hamburger menu

Weaknesses

- "Powered by WordPress.com" visible in footer
- No unique visual identity beyond the theme defaults
- Card layouts are inconsistent (some have images, some don't)
- Footer is minimal (copyright + 1 social link)
- No visual hierarchy to guide users to key actions

- Hero section with community photo is warm and inviting
- Secondary nav CTAs are well-positioned
- Mobile: large logo takes significant viewport space

Typography Stack

USAGE	FONT	SOURCE
Headings	Merriweather (serif)	Google Fonts via wp.com
Body Text	Source Sans Pro (sans-serif)	Google Fonts via wp.com
Fallback Stack	-apple-system, BlinkMacSystemFont, Segoe UI, Roboto	

Color Palette (Current Site)

#f2dc99	#10a510	#088008	#353833	#ffffff
Background	Buttons	Links	Footer	Cards

ACTION PLAN

Recommendations

Quick Wins — Low effort, high impact

1. **Fix the meta description.** Replace the WordPress theme boilerplate with a real description: e.g., *"Curtis Park Neighbors is Denver's Curtis Park RNO and Historic District organization. Join us to preserve our neighborhood's history and plan for its future."*
2. **Add alt text to all images.** 10 of 11 images are missing descriptive alt attributes. Provide context-appropriate descriptions for each.
3. **Fix duplicate copy.** The "Maintaining Historic Homes" card shows ADU content. Replace with appropriate description of home maintenance resources.
4. **Fix broken link.** "Resources for Historic Homes" image links to `/character-defining-features/` instead of `/resources/`.
5. **Remove empty heading tags.** Delete or populate the 3 empty H2/H3 elements found on the homepage.
6. **Add CAPTCHA to contact form.** Enable Jetpack's built-in anti-spam or add reCAPTCHA to prevent automated submissions.

Medium Effort — Moderate effort, meaningful improvement

7. **Add Schema.org structured data.** Implement JSON-LD for NonprofitOrganization, Event, and BreadcrumbList to improve search presence and enable rich results.
8. **Replace hardcoded events with a calendar solution.** Use a WordPress events plugin or embed Google Calendar to reduce manual maintenance and provide iCal feeds.
9. **Modernize mailing lists.** Migrate from Google Groups mailto: links to a proper email marketing platform with web signup forms, analytics, and templated newsletters.
10. **Add a message body field to the contact form.** Users currently can only submit name/email/phone with no way to explain their inquiry.
11. **Install Google Analytics and Search Console.** Jetpack Stats alone does not provide the depth needed for understanding visitor behavior, search performance, or conversion tracking.
12. **Convert images to WebP format.** All current images are JPEG. WebP provides 25-35% smaller files with equivalent quality.

Strategic Investments — Higher effort, transformative impact

13. **Platform migration.** Move from WordPress.com managed hosting to self-hosted WordPress.org (or a modern static framework) for full plugin control, custom development, and removal of "Powered by WordPress.com" branding.

14. **Homepage redesign.** Reduce page length by moving the Historic Home Alterations deep content to its own landing page. Add clear visual hierarchy guiding users toward key actions (donate, attend meeting, join mailing list).

15. **Integrate donation flow on-site.** Replace the external Square redirect with an embedded payment form to reduce friction, maintain trust, and enable donation analytics.

16. **Build an email newsletter system.** Create branded newsletter templates with proper subscriber management, replacing the current Google Groups approach with a professional communications platform.

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